Chapter 1

Some people said the town had not changed in a century, while others insisted that everything was different now. In the afternoon the light turned gold, and the old clock in the square ran four minutes late, as it always had.

Chapter 2

When the rain finally arrived, it fell for three days without a pause, and the fields became small lakes. The station master checked his watch twice, nodded at the driver, and the last train of the day pulled away.

Chapter 3

Engineers measured the water level every morning and wrote the numbers in a book that nobody else read. The station master checked his watch twice, nodded at the driver, and the last train of the day pulled away.